Cory Kratz

Technology Director | Client-Facing Technology Partner | Software Architect

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SUMMARY

Technology director with 14 years leading client-facing technology strategy and delivery for pharmaceutical, automotive, and enterprise accounts including Merck, Organon, Takeda, Dexcom, HP, Nissan, and Subaru. Scope and pitch new work, expand accounts through AI and development recommendations, and serve as the single escalation point for technology decisions across a 19-person distributed, remote-first engineering organization.

Partner with global directors and senior leadership, technical and non-technical, to roadmap CMS migrations, AI implementation goals, and omnichannel integrations, translating business priorities into practical, compliant, and scalable solutions. Sole Sitecore architect on two Fortune Global 500 builds, Komatsu's corporate site and a Merck enterprise property, with hands-on depth across AWS, Azure, Terraform, Node.js, Python, React, and .NET.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Client-Facing Technology Leadership · Technology Strategy & Roadmaps · Account Growth & SOW Scoping · Delivery Oversight & Escalations · Pharmaceutical & Life Sciences · Omnichannel Integrations · Solution Architecture · AI Strategy & Integrations · Software Security · Analytics & Tagging · Team Leadership · Veeva · Sitecore CMS · Cloud Architecture

SKILLS

Primary Stack

- Node.js, JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Next.js
- Python, Django, Flask
- C#, .NET Core, ASP.NET, Entity Framework
- Sitecore CMS, Veeva

Cloud & Infrastructure

- AWS, Azure, Terraform, Docker
- CI/CD, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Azure DevOps
- SQL Server, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MariaDB, MongoDB, Redis

Analytics & Data

- Adobe Analytics, Google Tag Manager, Meta (Facebook) Pixel
- Clickstream Tracking, Monthly Technical Website Reporting

Architecture & APIs

- System Design, Cloud Architecture, Microservices
- REST APIs, GraphQL, CMS Integrations
- RabbitMQ, Kafka

Security & Authentication

- Software Security, Secure Integration Design
- OAuth2, OpenID Connect, JWT, SSO
- Ongoing security education, including DEF CON

Delivery & Operations

- Git, GitHub, GitLab, Azure Repos
- Agile, Scrum, DevOps
- Linux, Bash, PowerShell, WSL

Frontend & Tooling

- Vue, Nuxt.js, Tailwind CSS, Bootstrap, Sass
- Webpack, Babel, Vite
- Responsive Design

Testing & Quality

- Unit Testing, Integration Testing
- Jest, xUnit, Pytest
- ESLint, Prettier

AI Tooling

- OpenAI APIs, AI Workflows, Prompt Engineering
- LangChain, LlamaIndex
- Hugging Face Transformers
- TensorFlow, PyTorch (basic familiarity)

Leadership & Client Delivery

- Client-Facing Technology Leadership
- SOW Scoping, Estimation & Pitching
- Account Growth & Expansion
- Escalation Ownership & Delivery Risk
- Senior Stakeholder Communication
- Technology Roadmapping
- Cross-Functional Collaboration
- Requirements Gathering & Analysis
- Team Leadership & Mentorship
- Hiring & Interviewing
- Architecture Decision-Making
- Product Strategy & Planning
- User-Centered Development Approach

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Associate Director, Technology

Omnicom Production | Chicago, IL (Remote) | 2016 – Present

Software Engineer 2016 – 2017 → **Senior Software Engineer** 2017 – 2019 → **Lead Software Engineer** 2019 – 2022 → **Architect** 2022 – 2023 → **Associate Director, Technology** 2023 – Present

Five roles in one continuous tenure, including the Designory to Omnicom Production organizational transition.

- Serve as the senior, client-facing technology partner for pharmaceutical and life sciences accounts including Merck, Organon, Takeda, and Dexcom, providing proactive technology counsel and guiding platform, integration, and architecture decisions within regulated review processes.
- Scaled and led a distributed 19-person engineering organization (8 onshore engineers plus 6 nearshore and 5 offshore developers across four partner teams), delivering 15+ enterprise landing platforms, interactive decision tools, and branded web experiences annually, reducing average deployment time by 40% while lowering delivery costs and sustaining high quality and client satisfaction.
- Scoped statements of work and pitched new business for accounts including HP and Organon, among others, and expanded existing accounts by bringing in AI budget and development recommendations.
- Partner with global directors and senior leadership across technical and non-technical disciplines to roadmap project milestones, including the migration and modernization of website CMS platforms alongside AI implementation goals for a $1B+ annual revenue corporation.
- Scope and estimate pharmaceutical projects on a near-weekly basis and serve as the escalation point for all technology matters, owning delivery risk, tradeoffs, and dependencies across concurrent workstreams.
- Technical director for omnichannel delivery teams spanning email and multichannel presentations, including Veeva development and clickstream tracking recommendations, setting consistent technical direction and quality standards across workstreams.
- Collaborate with QA on every project and partner with strategy, SEO, and marketing campaign departments to deliver integrated work that stays aligned with client objectives.
- Direct custom cross-platform integrations for omnichannel data collection and sharing where permitted, with security treated as a first-order requirement, and consult on Adobe Analytics, Google Tag Manager, and Meta Pixel implementations that inform monthly technical website reporting.
- Built branded product microsites, unbranded non-product websites, and campaign landing pages for pharmaceutical clients, applying a working understanding of regulatory review to deliver compliant, launch-ready properties with reusable implementation patterns.
- Designed and implemented a multi-tenant, API-driven content management platform for automotive clients, enabling 10k+ monthly content updates with automated asset generation and review workflows.
- Architected, launched, and maintained Sitecore 9.3 CMS solutions, website restructures, and enterprise web applications for healthcare, manufacturing, and automotive clients, improving content publishing efficiency by an estimated 35% and resolving ADA compliance gaps to raise accessibility scores from failing to WCAG-aligned passing thresholds across key marketing properties.
- Built a Unity Forma-based 3D vehicle configurator with API-driven asset generation and Jira-automated review, QA routing, and issue tracking, producing 10k+ approved assets per month, cutting manual asset production by 70%, and reducing creative approval turnaround by 45%.
- Modernized the Nissan Web Configurator to support static 3D image review workflows, improving review throughput and preserving brand consistency across multi-market releases.
- Designed cloud and automation strategies across AWS, Azure, and Terraform-backed environments while mentoring engineers on modern DevOps, CI/CD, and scalable system design practices.
- Led AI and automation initiatives including workflow-assisted content production, asset review pipelines, and intelligent tooling integrations to reduce repetitive manual operations.

BadgerMeter HP Cisco Uber Komatsu Nissan Subaru Takeda Merck MMC Metlife Case-IH Dexcom Fujifilm Valero Organon Prudential

Senior Software Engineer

ProWest & Associates | Walker, MN (Remote) | 2012 – 2016

- Developed and maintained 5+ enterprise and public-sector web applications using C# Web Forms, ASP.NET MVC, Dojo, Node.js, Python, and SQL Server for county permitting, inspection, and chemistry data reporting workflows.
- Automated data download, transformation, and database ingestion with Python scripting, reducing manual processing time by an estimated 60%.
- Built multi-threaded Windows services for print queue processing, logging, and notification workflows that improved system reliability and reduced support intervention.
- Designed application enhancements for infrastructure and sign inspection systems, helping county teams manage higher field volumes with cleaner reporting and audit visibility.

Chisago County | St Louis County | Potlatch | Cook County, IL

EARLIER CAREER

TTS Manager

Carlson Wagonlit Travel / CWTSatoTravel | Ely, MN | 2003 – 2012

- Promoted from lead through trainer and supervisor to manager of 4 call center locations and 104 employees, serving as primary point of contact for multiple multimillion-dollar commercial and government accounts.
- Raised productivity 30%+ and revenue 15% while cutting costs 9.3%, and led global initiatives that earned the operation the #1 site ranking in North America.
- Built the department's first technical tooling, including VBA-automated reporting, a shared intranet hub used across all four centers, and an Access database for airline debit-memo tracking, then left management to restart as a full-time programmer.

EDUCATION

- B.S. Computer Science, Bemidji State University

CERTIFICATIONS

- Sitecore 9.3 Certified